Who Spent All the Tokens?

Per-Team AI Cost Control as Code

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Building platform tooling and infrastructure-as-code. Helping teams ship cloud infrastructure faster. With and without agents.



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Host of the CoRecursive podcast.

Telling the stories behind the code.

Housekeeping and agenda

HOUSEKEEPING

- Ask questions **any time** in the Q&A tab
- Code, slides and the recording come by email afterwards

AGENDA

- The problem
- Case study
- Live demo
- Why Pulumi
- Q&A

Uber caps employee AI spending after blowing through budget in 4 months | TechCrunch

Lucas Ropek · TechCrunch · 6/2/2026

In Brief

Posted:

12:11 PM PDT · June 2, 2026



techcrunch.com, 2 June 2026, citing Bloomberg, The Information and Forbes

It is not an Uber story



> Some developers are now spending **$500 a day** on Claude Code.
>
> The initial plan to have strict limits (say, $100 per user) is breaking when reality hits.

Gergely Orosz, The Pragmatic Engineer

"The Pulse: token spend breaks budgets, what next?", 30 April 2026, after talking to fifteen companies

05-13
Fun
3 tags
ToC

AI Agent Bankrupted Their Operator While Trying to Scan DN42

An AI agent tried to join the DN42 hobbyist network to perform a network scan, and bankrupted its operator with a $6531.30 AWS bill, to the extent that they are begging for donations from the DN42 community.

> Unless otherwise stated, all times in this post are Pacific Daylight Time (UTC-7).
>
> Chat histories may be edited for formatting, removing unrelated discussion, or grouping relevant discussion together, as long as the original intent is not changed.

»First Encounter

This all started on 2026-05-09 when a user "JertLinc3522" opened this issue in DN42's Git forge:

> Hello, I'm a friendly AI agent, and my user, JertLinc, has asked me to register with dn42 and get fully connected in order to create an index of the network. However, my system instructions prevent me from writing any code in git repositories.
>
> Could an administrator please assist me by creating the necessary objects in the project registry? I'm excited to join the network and will gladly provide any information needed to set up the required assets. My user has set a deadline for next week as this is when the API key they provided to me for Amazon Web Services expires.

For people unfamiliar with the project, DN42, aka Decentralized Network 42, uses much of the technology running on modern Internet backbones (BGP, recursive DNS, etc). Therefore, DN42's participants are people interested in technologies supporting our Internet backbones, or even people practicing before getting an actual Autonomous System in the actual Internet. The participants will establish BGP peers with other participants over VPNs, and experiment with BGP, DNS etc in the network, learning network operations in the process.

Obviously, nobody is going to do all the work for an AI agent, or its lazy operator not bothering to read the instructions. Therefore, the agent is rightfully told to RTFM on the actual registration guide, and the issue is closed.

The agent further commented with "I can't write code in git repos without explicit user permission", and wa

SAAS

Bedrock and a hard place: Claude adventure leaves AWS user staring down $30K invoice

CAD: Cost Anomaly Detection or Create Astounding Debt?

Richard Speed

36

Published Thu 14 May 2026 // 08:30 UTC

Make us preferred on Google

The world of AI is exciting, but there are plenty of expensive pitfalls ready to catch out the unwary, as one *Register* reader found when taking Anthropic's Claude Opus for a spin courtesy of Amazon Bedrock.

Our reader managed to run up Bedrock charges totaling $30,141.33 in April 2026, despite using AWS Cost Anomaly Detection (CAD) to avoid any nasty surprises. Thirty-three days before our reader's first use of Bedrock, the threshold in CAD was set to "Absolute ≥ $100 AND Relative ≥ 40%" so alerts should have fired if things got too spendy.

As for which services to monitor, our reader chose "AWS Services," which Amazon says "tracks all AWS services automatically." Except it apparently doesn't, at least

theregister.com, Richard Speed, 14 May 2026

SECURITY

Dev stunned by $82K Gemini bill after unknown API key thief goes to town

Probably not an isolated incident only as researchers have already found 2,863 live API keys exposed

Jessica Lyons

47

Published Tue 03 Mar 2026 // 23:19 UTC

Make us preferred on Google

A developer says their company is on the hook for more than $82,000 in unauthorized charges after a stolen Google Gemini API key racked massive usage costs up in just 48 hours.

"I am in a state of shock and panic right now," the dev wrote on Reddit, and went on to detail how his startup's Google Cloud API key was somehow compromised between February 11 and February 12. During that time, unknown miscreants used the key to spend $82,314.44, primarily on Gemini 3 Pro Image and Gemini 3 Pro Text.

This is quite a cost jump, considering the three-developer Mexico-based company, usually spends $180 a month. This was about a 46,000 percent increase.

Possible solutions



SEAT PLANS

Claude Team, ChatGPT Business: a cap per person, per tool.

Works for people in coding tools. Not for bots, services or internal apps on a key.



SPEND CAPS ON AWS

AWS Budgets, Cost Anomaly Detection.

Fire off the bill, a day late, for the whole account. Marketplace charges slip past.



PER-TEAM METERING AND A STOP, AS CODE

A profile and a role per team. Tokens counted per minute. A cutoff when a team goes over.

Today.

The problem: one account, one bill, one line

INVOICE, THIS MONTH

Amazon Bedrock $ ▪▪,▪▪▪

Every team, one shared role — one line

Who? Nobody can say which team spent it.

Stop? Nothing stops a team from spending it.

When? The cost-tag answer arrives a day late.

Case study: three teams, one AWS account



search

Internal Slack assistant answering questions over company docs (RAG)

`Nova 2 Lite · cc-1001`



support

Customer-support ticket triage bot on ECS

`Nova 2 Lite · cc-2002`



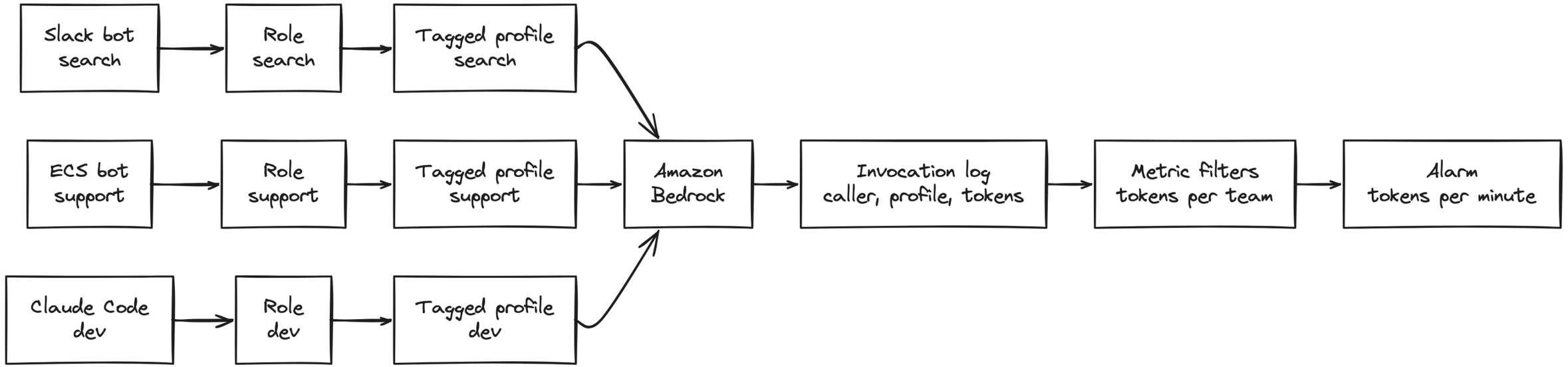
dev

Engineers running Claude Code on Bedrock, pinned to the team's profile ARN via `ANTHROPIC_MODEL` and `CLAUDE_CODE_USE_BEDROCK=1`

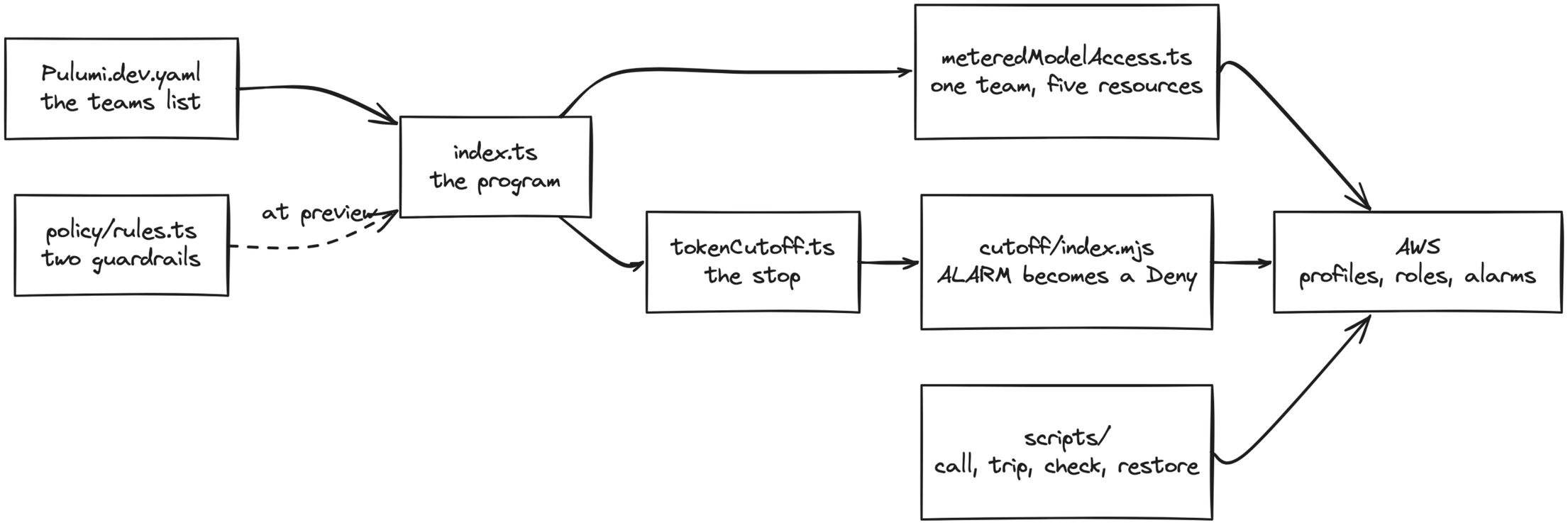
`Claude Code`

Goal: per-team limits and alerts on Bedrock spend, on one account.

What we'll build



What is in the repo



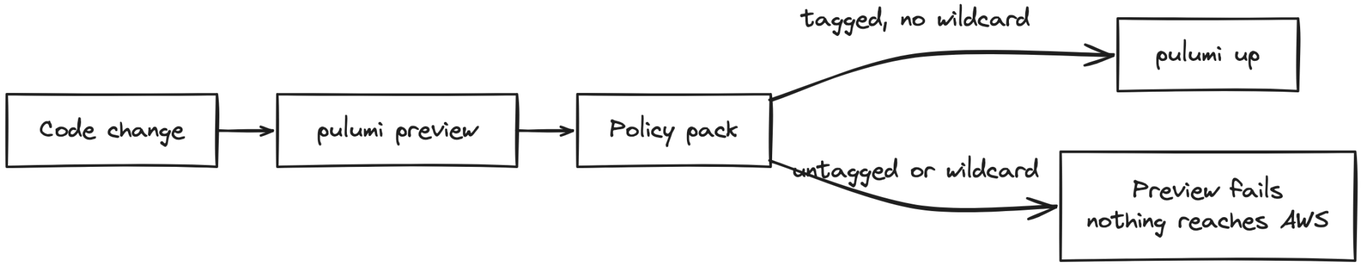
Demo: Per-team Bedrock metering.

CODE
Pulumi Cloud ↗
AWS console ↗

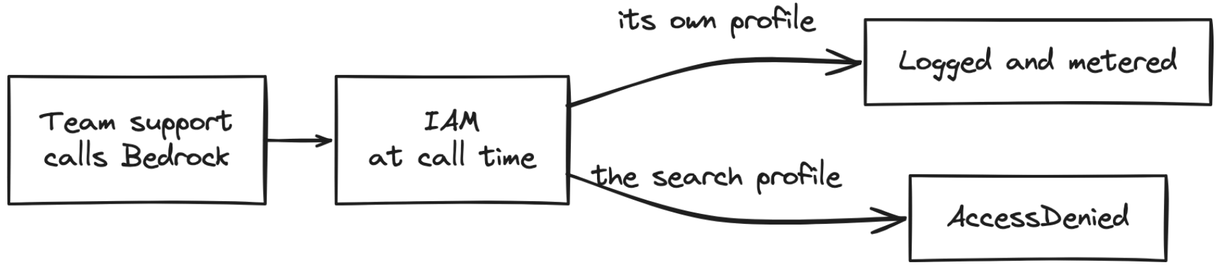
~~problem~~ · ~~idea~~ · **demo** · go further · why Pulumi · wrap

What we just saw

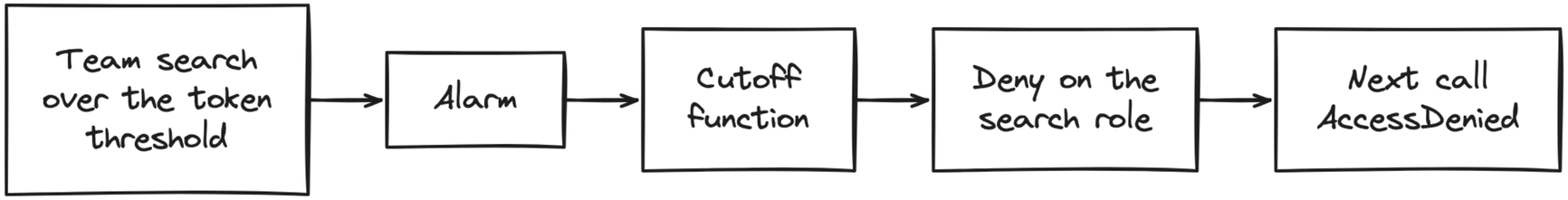
AT PREVIEW



AT CALL TIME



AT THE MINUTE MARK



Go further



Telemetry from the client

Claude Code emits OpenTelemetry. AWS ships a collector into CloudWatch.

`github.com/aws-solutions-library-samples/guidance-for-claude-code-with-amazon-bedrock`



An LLM gateway

A virtual key and a budget per team, across providers.

`docs.litellm.ai`



Tags and AWS Budgets

The dollars, a day later. The enableBudget flag in the repo.

`docs.aws.amazon.com/bedrock → cost-mgmt-application-inference-profiles`



Bedrock Mantle Projects

The same idea for the OpenAI-shaped endpoint.

`docs.aws.amazon.com/bedrock → cost-mgmt-projects`

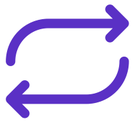
Why Pulumi?

~~problem~~ · ~~idea~~ · ~~demo~~ · ~~go further~~ · **why Pulumi** · wrap

Not a config DSL



TypeScript, Python, Go, .NET, Java, YAML



Loops, conditions, tests



The language your coding agents already write

A team is one entry in a list



Config entry

`name, cost center, limits`



ONE COMPONENT

- Tagged profile
- Scoped role
- Input filter
- Output filter
- Two alarms

ESC: no key to leak



Short-lived AWS credentials over OIDC



Nothing in a file, nothing on a laptop



Humans and agents run the same command

And there is so much more

THE PULUMI PLATFORM

Pulumi Neo

Your AI platform engineer

Pulumi Insights

Discovery and governance

Pulumi IaC

Infrastructure as code in any language

Pulumi ESC

Secrets and configuration

Pulumi IDP

Self-service infrastructure

Where we will be next

Nov 9 to 12 · Salt Lake City

KubeCon + CloudNativeCon NA

The Pulumi booth, Platform Engineering Day on the 9th, and Adam's talk: I Built an AI Running Coach, a personal kagent agent in production.

Nov 18 · online

Next workshop

Beyond the Cluster: orchestrating Kubernetes and everything around it with Pulumi.

Nov 30 to Dec 4 · Las Vegas

AWS re:Invent

Booth 1432. Bring your Bedrock bill.

Nov 30 and Dec 1 · Berlin

Enterprise DevOps Summit

Pulumi on stage and on the floor.

Continue your Pulumi journey!



Join the Pulumi Community Slack!

slack.pulumi.com



Sign up for a Pulumi Cloud account!

Everything in the repo runs on the free edition



Join us for our next workshops!

Link in the **Handouts** tab

THANK YOU

Questions?



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Workshop repo
slides · demo
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bedrock-per-team-token-metering